

Zscaler, Inc.

CRO Transition Never Good to See, but Ross Tackett Offers Some Continuity; Expect More on 10/6 Analyst Day

After market close today, ZS announced CRO transition - Mike Rich is stepping aside and Head of WW Sales Ross Tackett is taking over - no reiteration of guidance with announcement, we wonder if it will happen at upcoming Analyst Day.

Two thoughts on ZS's CRO transition announced this afternoon: (1) CRO Mike Rich is stepping aside starting October 1st, while head of WW sales Ross Tackett is taking over – some investors wondered if this was transition would happen, and its never good to see a well-regarded exec leave; (2) We do not think this CRO transition was known when ZS provided FY guide, so we understand the question on why no reiteration of guide – but we also think Mr. Tackett helped heavily shape this guide as WW Sales head, and so combined with the upcoming October 6th analyst day, we wonder if we might hear that reiteration then.

- **ZS CRO Mike Rich stepping aside starting October 1st, while head of WW sales Ross Tackett taking over – some investors wondered if this transition would happen, its never good to see well-regarded execs leave.** Chief Revenue Officer (CRO) Mike Rich is stepping away from his role starting October 1st, while Head of WW Sales Ross Tackett is taking over, with Mr. Rich remaining as an advisor through the end of this calendar year. Some investors have been wondering if this transition would happen over the last couple quarters for various reasons, and so it may not come as a surprise to some – but it is never good to see a well-regarded executive leave at a time when there are questions around competition and the slope of ARR growth. The decision here sounds driven by personal factors, but some investors have wondered if Mr. Rich might show up at another big company, which could change the implication of this departure – but we will have to wait and see if that will happen or not. All this said, it is important to note that Mr. Tackett has been at ZS for three years, has led Americas Sales, Worldwide Sales, and had worked with Mr. Rich at ServiceNow (NOW/covered by Raimo Lenschow) before coming to ZS.
- **CRO transition was not contemplated in guide, but we would note Ross Tackett contributed heavily to the forecast – we got the question on why no reiteration of guide, but we wonder if that will come at October 6th analyst day.** On the last earnings call, we heard Mr. Rich's name mentioned so we do not believe his departure was contemplated in the

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ZS

U.S. Software

Price Target

Price (23-Sep-26)

Potential Upside/Downside

Source: Bloomberg, Barclays Research

OVERWEIGHT

POSITIVE

USD 200.00

USD 214.45

-6.7%

U.S. Software

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guide – so we understand the question of why ZS is not reiterating guide. But its important to note that as Head of WW sales, Mr. Tackett helped shape ZS's forecast, and so there is a strong element of continuity and we wonder if that contributed to the decision to not reiterate guide with this announcement. Furthermore, remember that ZS is hosting analyst day in less than two weeks on October 6th, and we would not be surprised to hear more about confidence in the forecast at that event.

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Primary Stocks (Ticker, Date, Price)

Zscaler, Inc. (ZS, 23-Sep-2026, USD 214.45), Overweight/Positive, CE/FA/J/K/M

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Gen Digital Inc. (GEN)	GitLab Inc. (GTLB)	Hinge Health, Inc. (HNGE)

HubSpot, Inc. (HUBS)	IBM Corp. (IBM)	Intapp, Inc. (INTA)
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Sprout Social, Inc. (SPT)	Tenable Holdings Inc (TENB)	Teradata Corp. (TDC)
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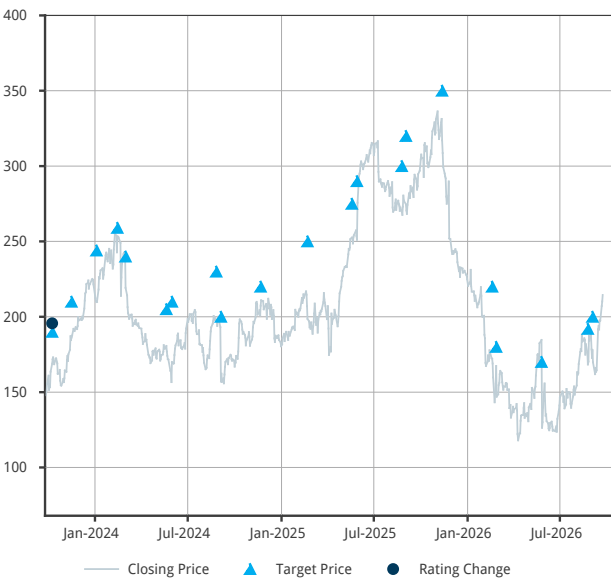
Zscaler, Inc. (ZS / ZS)

Stock Rating: **OVERWEIGHT**

Industry View: **POSITIVE**

Closing Price: **USD 214.45** (23-Sep-2026)

Rating and Price Target Chart (as of 23-Sep-2026)



Source: LSEG Data & Analytics, Bloomberg, Barclays Research

[Link to Barclays Live for interactive charting](#)

Publication Date	Closing Price*	Rating	Adjusted Price Target	Currency
03-Sep-2026	177.80		200.00	USD
25-Aug-2026	181.75		192.00	USD
26-May-2026	184.60		170.00	USD
26-Feb-2026	167.36		180.00	USD
18-Feb-2026	172.13		220.00	USD
12-Nov-2025	331.29		350.00	USD
02-Sep-2025	277.05		320.00	USD
25-Aug-2025	270.35		300.00	USD
29-May-2025	251.11		290.00	USD
19-May-2025	251.50		275.00	USD
21-Feb-2025	206.97		250.00	USD
21-Nov-2024	200.94		220.00	USD
04-Sep-2024	193.19		200.00	USD
26-Aug-2024	197.78		230.00	USD
31-May-2024	156.65		210.00	USD
20-May-2024	178.86		205.00	USD
01-Mar-2024	241.97		240.00	USD
14-Feb-2024	242.80		259.00	USD
04-Jan-2024	210.24		244.00	USD
16-Nov-2023	187.09		210.00	USD
09-Oct-2023	153.30	Overweight	190.00	USD

On 24-Sep-2023, prior to any intra-day change that may have been published, the rating for this security was Equal Weight, and the adjusted price target was 176.00 USD.

Source: Bloomberg, Barclays Research

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